

Grow2Guide

Accreditation Starter Checklist

A practical readiness checklist for behavioral health organizations preparing for licensure, CARF, or Joint Commission review.

Companion to the Behavioral Health Policy Inventory & Learning Guide

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Educational resource. Not legal advice, certification, or a guarantee of accreditation outcomes. Confirm current standards with the responsible authority before submission.

How to use this checklist

Work through each section with your leadership team. Mark items as **Done**, **In progress**, or **Gap**. Gaps become your remediation roadmap — and a natural next step into Grow2Guide Readiness or Full Build support if you need help closing them.

Tip: attach evidence links or file names in the Notes column so survey prep stays organized.

1. Governance & leadership

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Governing body / ownership structure documented	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Mission, vision, and service description current	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Org chart with reporting lines for clinical and admin leadership	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Leadership meeting cadence and decision log in place	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Conflict of interest / ethics expectations documented	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

2. Policies, procedures & forms

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Policy inventory covers HR, operations, QA, compliance/risk, safety, clinical	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Each critical policy has a matching procedure and form where needed	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Version control and review dates visible on policies	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Staff acknowledgment / training record process exists	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Incident, grievance, and privacy policies are current and trained	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

3. Human resources & credentials

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Job descriptions match actual roles	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Credential, license, and background-check files complete for staff	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Orientation and ongoing training matrix defined	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Supervision structure documented for clinical staff	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Personnel file checklist used consistently	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

4. Clinical / service delivery

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Admission, exclusion, and discharge criteria defined	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Assessment and treatment-planning workflow documented	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Documentation standards and audit sample process exist	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Care coordination / referral partnerships listed	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Crisis / emergency response procedures trained	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

5. Quality assurance & performance

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
QA / QI plan with measures and owners	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Incident trending and corrective-action process	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Client rights, grievance, and satisfaction feedback loop	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Chart / documentation audit schedule	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Leadership review of QA findings on a set cadence	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

6. Compliance, privacy & risk

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
HIPAA / 42 CFR Part 2 (as applicable) consents and notices	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Breach / privacy incident response plan	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Risk assessment completed within the last 12 months	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Vendor / BAA inventory for systems handling PHI	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Record retention schedule defined	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

7. Safety & environment

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Emergency preparedness / evacuation procedures	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Infection control and medication safety (if applicable)	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Facility safety checks / maintenance log	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	
Staff safety training documented	■ Done ■ In progress ■ Gap	

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Unusual incident / sentinel event escalation path	☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Gap	

8. Survey / inspection readiness

Item	Status	Notes / Evidence
Target authority identified (state license, CARF, Joint Commission, CCBHC, DFS, other)	☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Gap	
Standards crosswalk started against current requirements	☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Gap	
Evidence binder / shared folder organized by standard	☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Gap	
Mock interview questions practiced with staff	☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Gap	
Corrective-action owners assigned for known gaps	☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Gap	

Next steps

1. Tally your Gaps by section.
2. Prioritize critical and high-risk items first.
3. If you need a structured gap analysis and roadmap, Grow2Guide's Readiness pathway is designed for that stage.
4. Pair this checklist with the **Behavioral Health Policy Inventory & Learning Guide** so staff understand why the systems exist.